



Public Services Committee July 22, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bq4mne3ZrDE
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Municipal Meeting Report: Public Service Committee

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The regular meeting was preceded by a public service committee work session focused entirely on municipal financing and development.

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Service Committee Work Session [00:01:45](#) — Discussion concerning the proposed financing, development, and construction of Fire Station Number 5.
- **Summary of Discussion:**
 - Representatives from the bond council firm (Bose McKinney & Evans), financial advisors (LWG Consulting / London Witty Group), GM Development, and the city controller's office presented details on the proposed \$11.5 million project.
 - Discussion centered on the lease financing structure (utilized due to statutory 2% direct debt limits under Indiana law), local income tax (LIT) and economic development income tax (EDIT) funding sources, grant opportunities, operating cost impacts, and the 20-year capital facilities plan.
 - Committee members raised questions regarding a \$1.5 million lump-sum contribution pledge from Ball State University, exploring whether the total bond ask could be reduced from \$11.5 million to \$10 million. Bond counsel advised retaining full authorization to prevent potential funding shortfalls.

- Additional discussions covered the temporary relocation facility on Jackson Street (leased from Ball Hospital for \$1/year with approximately \$400,000 in required modifications), construction contingencies, utilization of local and union labor, and anticipated timelines once formal approvals are granted.
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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the July 22nd Public Service meeting [00:01:24](#).
 - **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Committee members including Jeff Green, Jerry, and other council/committee members; Dennis (Bose McKinney & Evans); Bob Swintz (LWG Consulting); Greg Marts (GM Development); Craig Wright (Controller's Office); Chief and fire department representatives; Jason Chaffen (Local 1348 President).
 - **Absent:** Mayor and municipal administration leadership explicitly noted as absent by committee members [00:02:46](#).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jeff Green [00:00:43](#), followed by a moment of silence for fallen soldiers [00:01:01](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed in the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:37:32](#) **Ordinance 9-26 (and related Resolutions 10-26 & 11-26): Fire Station 5 Financing, Appropriation, and BOT Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by Dennis (Bose McKinney & Evans), Bob Swintz (LWG Consulting), Greg Marts (GM Development), and city fire officials.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed review of the \$11.5 million lease financing structure through a building corporation, utilizing EDIT and LIT revenue sources. The project includes the demolition of the existing outdated station and the setup of a temporary operational facility at Jackson Street.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - [00:31:14](#) **Jason Chaffen** (President, Local 1348) spoke during the proceedings urging prompt action on the project due to severe maintenance issues and aging infrastructure at the current 65-year-old station (noting recent water line failures).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** A motion was made for a favorable recommendation to the city council regarding Ordinance 9-26. **Approved by Voice Vote** (with recorded

abstentions on the voice vote).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: General citizen forum comments were integrated directly into the committee's work session and expert questioning period rather than held as a separate standalone session.

- **00:31:14 Jason Chaffen** (Local 1348 President): Addressed the committee regarding the urgency of replacing Fire Station 5 due to its age and deteriorating infrastructure (mentioning recent water line breaks).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Committee members requested that financial spending plans, future LIT revenue models, and exact counts of existing municipal lease financing structures be brought to the upcoming full city council meeting.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made following the committee vote **00:04:48**.
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